Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 1 · Tuesday 23 February 2027 · P1

Lesson

A story with a short role-play

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Use freeze-frame/role-play to tell a story.

Today I can

I can keep first, next and last clear.

I can add one action or short line.

I can share and log a real choice.

Prepare

For three to four pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

Clear a safe acting area. Keep chairs available for seated work.

No props, costumes, devices or sound equipment are needed.

Retain the three-part plans and dated observations for the next lesson.

Cover route

Use yesterday's story plans if available. Model a new lost prop story for anyone without one. Add one silent action or short line between still poses. Rehearse, gather one specific viewer note and make one change. Record only today's actual contribution and sharing. The lesson lasts 40 minutes.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: We can build on yesterday or make a fresh lost prop story. Missing work is not a problem to hide. We record what we do today. Choose how to join in and check the open-hand stop cue.

Look for: Every pupil has access to a usable story, including absent pupils.

Fallback: Adult recalls the lost prop model in three hand poses. Pupil chooses a beginning or end.

Check and response: A recovered plan and a fresh plan are both valid. Do not backdate a new plan.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: I show the empty shelf. A helper might say: Where is the prop? Or the helper can point in silence. Which helps our story?

Look for: Pupil recalls a pose and selects a possible short line or action.

Fallback: Offer two lines: Where is it? or Here it is! Ask which fits this pose.

Check and response: Where is it? fits the problem; Here it is! fits the ending. Silent mime can communicate either.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I keep the same order. I start in my empty-hands pose, say one short line at talking level, mime looking in the box and end in my found-prop pose. I try rushing, then add a pause. The pause gives the viewer time. I do not need to shout.

Look for: Adult models brief role-play bounded by two poses and tests a pause.

Fallback: Do the full sequence seated with hand mime and a whispered or adult-spoken line.

Check and response: The first line shows the problem. The move shows the search. The final line and pose show the result. Ask: Which bit shows the search?

We do 6 minutes

Say: You choose the line or mime. I will wait for the cue. Let us try a short pause before the end. The viewer says first and last. If the order is unclear, return to three still pictures and add only one move.

Look for: Each pupil contributes a line, action or directing decision. The group checks whether a viewer follows the order.

Fallback: Adult performs the pupil choices. Pupil points when the adult should pause.

Check and response: A viewer naming lost then found shows a clear order. If not, keep the freezes and add one action only. This is the hinge decision.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: In a pair or adult-supported group, agree one line or move per role. A directing job counts when it includes a real choice. Rehearse for a short agreed audience. Ask: Which part was clear? Change a pause, facing or cue. A silent version is complete.

Look for: The role-play retains a clear three-part story, an intentional addition and one revision informed by feedback.

Fallback: Make a seated hand drama. Adult voices the pupil-selected line. Pupil may direct a start and a pause without speaking.

Check and response: Example only: Where is the prop? Search mime. Here it is! A quiet original line or silent action is equally valid.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Choose a peer, a small group or the adult. Listen to one story detail. Ask the maker if the meaning was understood. In the last two minutes, reset chairs and store the plan beside the log.

Look for: Pupil has an agreed sharing moment and receives a specific, respectful observation.

Fallback: Adult repeats the chosen action, then reads the viewer note for confirmation.

Check and response: A useful note is: Your pause helped me see the ending. Comment on a choice, not on acting confidence or personal traits.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Keep your own words about the action or line you chose. I will date the record today and note the help used. If you did not share today, we write that honestly and plan a later private share.

Look for: Record distinguishes performance, creation and sharing actually completed, with an honest next step.

Fallback: Offer point, short phrase or dictated sentence. Read it back.

Check: Example only: I added a pause. The viewer saw the prop was found. Next time I will face front.

Evidence and review

Keep the actual story plan, dated observation and pupil-confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution and help used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. Model examples are never entered as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

Role-play needs lots of words - One short line or a silent action can tell the story.

A missing old plan means no lesson today - Make a fresh plan and date it today.

Feedback means telling someone they are good or bad - Notice a clear action, line, pose or pause and say how it helps the story.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: What helps us see the change?

higher: Which choice makes the story clearer, and why?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear bags and chairs from the acting area. Mark personal space by agreement; no touch, lifting, chasing, falls, climbing, weapons or thrown objects. Mime props. A still pose may be seated and lasts only a comfortable few seconds.

Emotional and sensory access

Agree an open-hand stop signal and a quiet return cue. Keep voices at talking level. Allow pass, private sharing and a calm pause. Do not use sudden noises, personal stories or forced eye contact.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story part at a time. Rehearse first, next and last. Use two choices and fade prompts.

Communication And Interaction: Offer point, sign, speech, drawing or a pupil-directed adult. Give thinking time. Repeat the pupil choice for confirmation.

Semh: Use invented roles. Agree audience and opt-out before rehearsal. Give each pupil a real choice without a public performance demand.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated, silent or directing roles. Keep walking pace and safe personal space. Stop if a pose is uncomfortable.

Eal: Plan in any language. Show freeze, move and share with gestures. Accept labels, drawings or an oral response before a full sentence.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Retain actual participation, exploration, creation and sharing evidence for the award. These lessons do not certify completion. Optional next level work in GROW is additional.

A pause, a request for help or a new plan can show resilience. Pupils do not need to act out real distress or tell a personal story.